# Practice workbook · Gregory's constructivist theory of perception

Top-down perception through perceptual hypotheses, inference and prior knowledge, with strengths and weaknesses.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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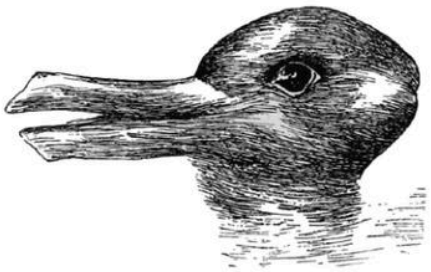
Type ID: PSY-PER-05

# 1. Question 25 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

**25** Rhonda is studying perception in her psychology class. Her teacher is discussing visual illusions and shows the class the picture below. She asks the class to discuss what they see in the picture, shown in **Figure 3**.



(Source: © Alpha Stock / Alamy Stock Photo)

**Figure 3**

Rhonda says that she sees a rabbit and points to the ears, but afterwards sees a duck and can no longer see any ears. She says that the image is constantly changing between the rabbit and the duck, but she cannot see both at the same time.

Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Gregory's constructivist theory of perception (1970) to account for Rhonda seeing two different images but not at the same time.

Strength

Weakness

**(Total for Question 25 = 4 marks)**

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## 1. Question 25 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 2. Question 25 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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**25** Carly perceived a car to be driving slowly. Jacob claimed this was because Carly has a prior understanding of speed and distance, which helped her determine the speed of the car. Carly did not agree, saying that her judgement of speed was based on optic flow.

Explain **one** reason that supports Jacob's claim.

You must use a theory to justify your answer.

**(Total for Question 25 = 2 marks)**

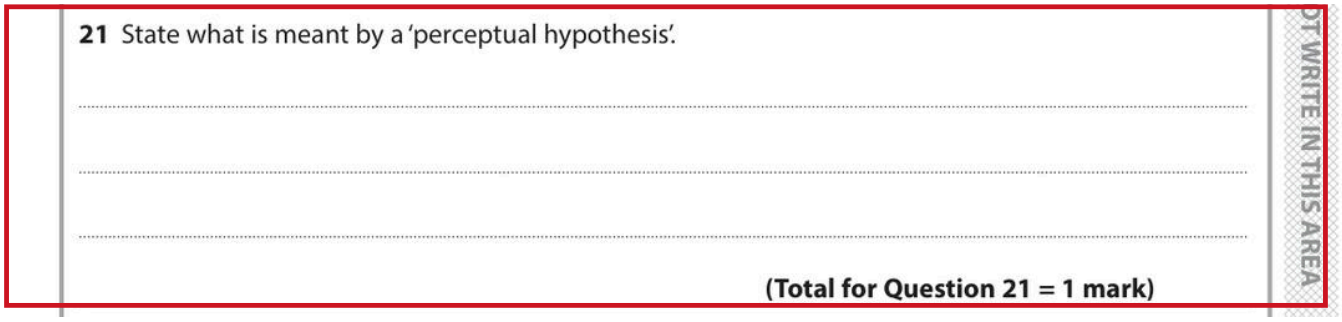
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Working and answer

## 3. Question 21 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.




Working and answer

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## 4. Question 28 · part whole · 9 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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***28** Archie was looking at the visual illusion in **Figure 4**.

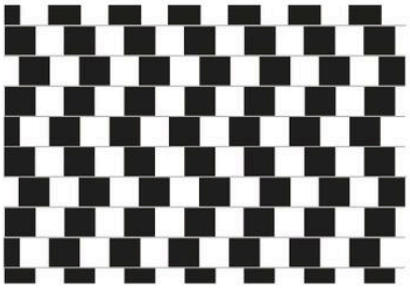


**Figure 4**

He perceived the lines to be sloping with each row becoming narrower to the left or right on alternating lines. Archie also perceived some of the squares to be of different heights at the start and end of a row.

Archie placed a ruler against each line and found each of the lines are perfectly horizontal and each row contains squares that are exactly the same height.

Assess how well the Constructivist Theory of Perception (Gregory, 1970) can explain Archie's perception of the illusion.

**(9)**

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33

*Turn over* ▶

## 4. Question 28 · part whole · 9 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



## 4. Question 28 · part whole · 9 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



## 4. Question 28 · part whole · 9 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 5. Question 25 · part whole · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

**25** Marigold was shown a visual illusion and asked to interpret what she perceived. The image she saw is shown in **Figure 1**. Marigold said she could see two different images in the visual illusion.

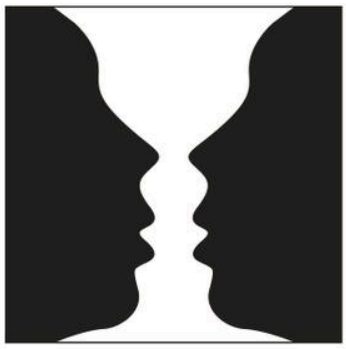


**Figure 1**

Explain **two** ways that Gregory's (1970) constructivist theory of perception could demonstrate why Marigold could perceive different images.

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**(Total for Question 25 = 4 marks)**

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## 5. Question 25 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 6. Question 24 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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**24** Alex was shown the unclear, blurred image in **Figure 4**.



**Figure 4**

(Source: Yasmin Said / EyeEm / Getty Images)

When looking at the image, Alex was able to identify that the image showed people crossing a street in a city.

Explain **one** reason why Alex was able to identify what was in the image shown in **Figure 4**.

You must use Gregory (1970) to justify your answer.

**(Total for Question 24 = 2 marks)**

## 6. Question 24 · part whole · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 7. Question 27 · part whole · 9 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

***27** Shamila was walking home from work when a person stole her bag. They were wearing a dark coat with the hood up. Shamila was frightened by the theft, and for several weeks she got a taxi home instead of walking. One day, Shamila decided to try walking home and asked a friend to walk with her.

After walking home, Shamila told her friend there had been six people who had stared at her bag, one of whom was planning to steal her bag because they had their hood up. Her friend said that she had not seen anyone staring at them and had not noticed a person with their hood up.

Assess how well the constructivist theory of perception (Gregory, 1970) can explain Shamila's perception.

**(9)**

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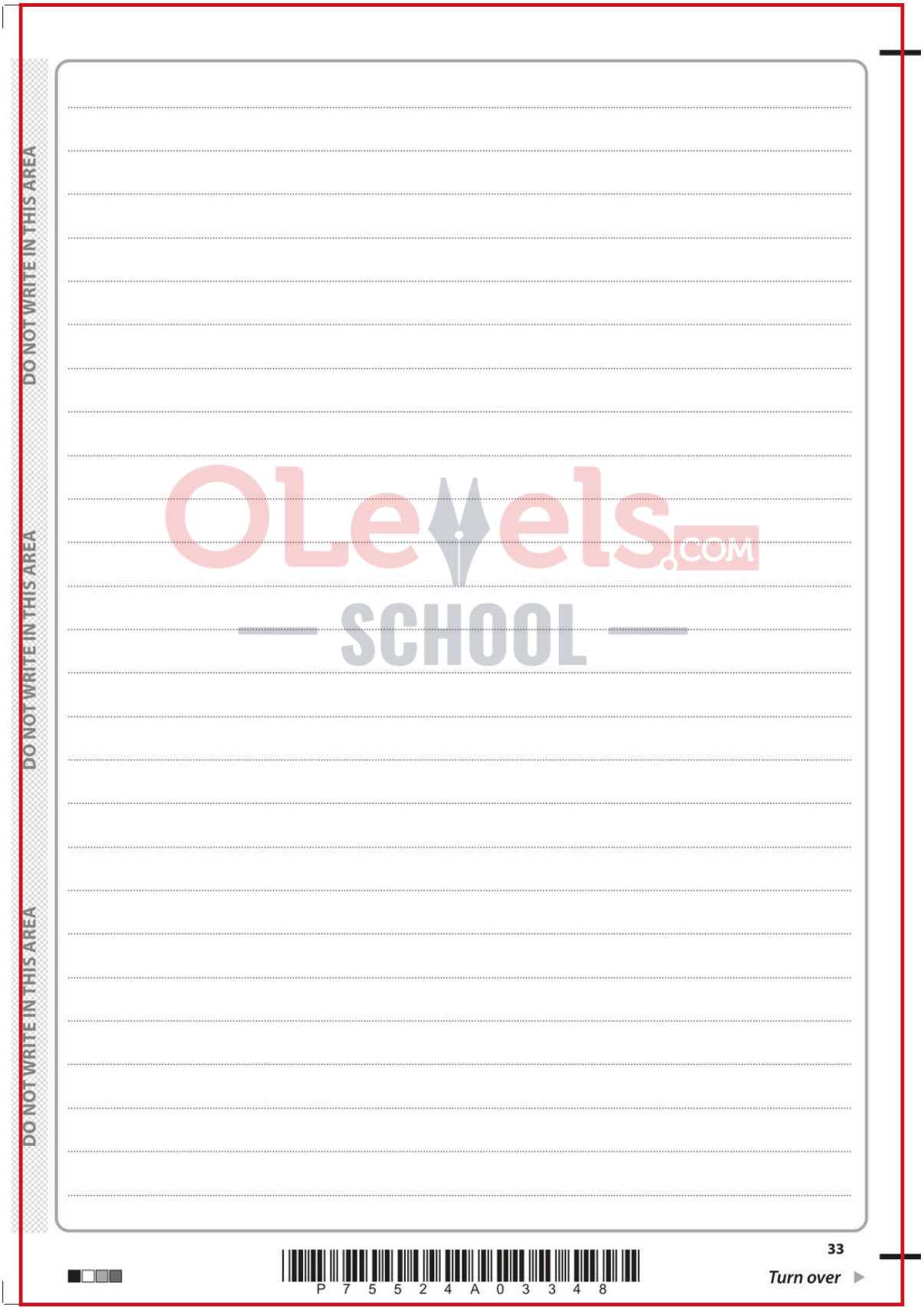
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## 7. Question 27 · part whole · 9 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

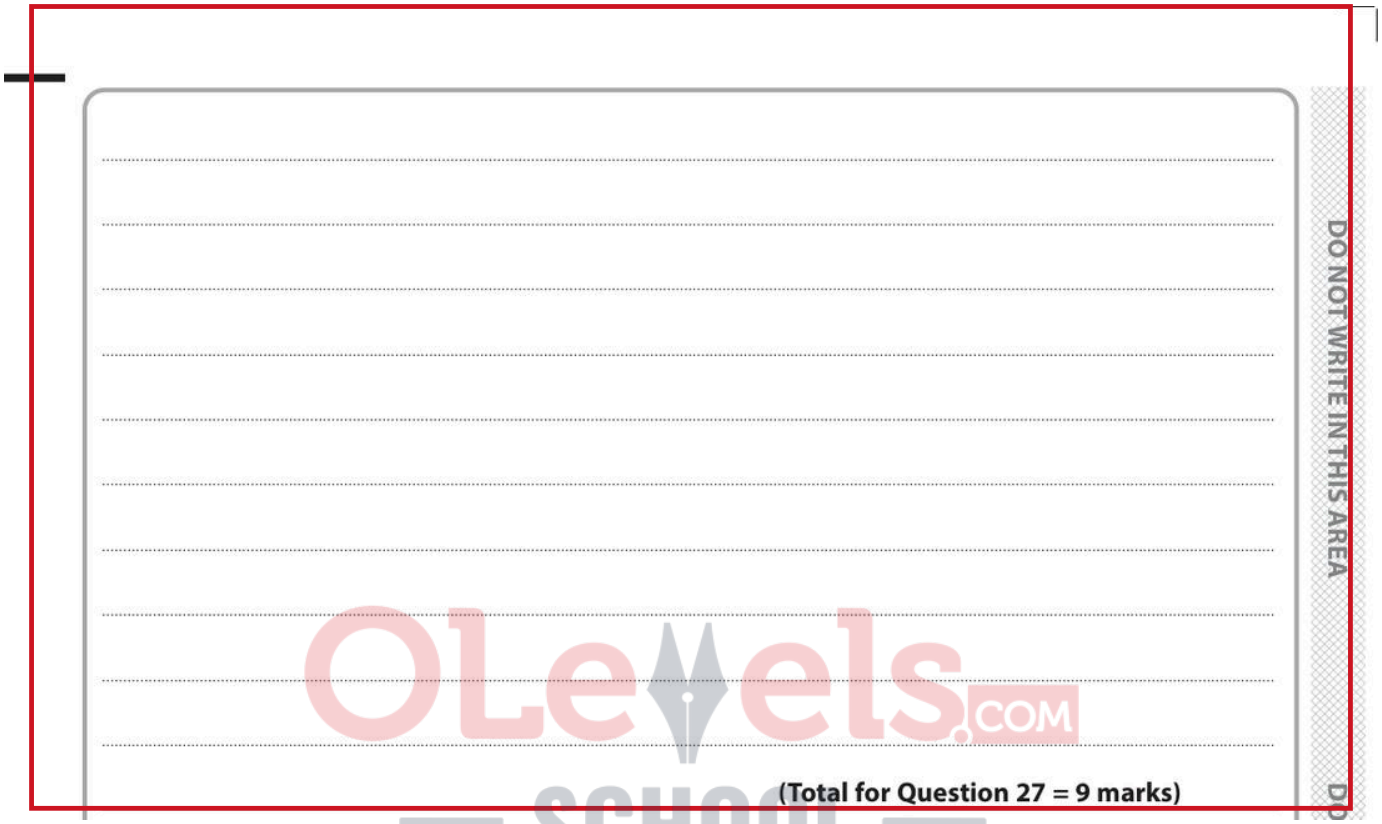
Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



## 7. Question 27 · part whole · 9 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.




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## 7. Question 27 · part whole · 9 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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